

to recreate the bits and pieces that are not longer present in modern OSs in Windows 7 / 8.

For instance DOS applications generally expect to be the only thing running on the computer. DOS application are also from a time before proper drivers, so software tended to interact with hardware like the sound card directly, so if your particular soundcard is not supported, the game might not play sound. Any emulator will need to recreate this as well.

Or, the second option is to put the game in the environment it expects by creating a virtual machine that has the OS they need installed on it, and the hardware they expect configured.

## Recreating the Software Environment

This approach is actually what Wine uses to run Windows applications on Linux. This is why it claims to not be an emulator. Just like Chrome is not a Firefox emulator just because it can run the same web applications that Firefox can, Wine is not a Windows emulator just because it can run the same software Windows can. Wine simply gives Windows applications a Windows environment on Linux.

Wine has been working on making Linux compatible with Windows since the Windows 3.1 days and can often run old Windows applications from the 95 / 98 and Windows 3.1 days better than recent versions of Windows. 16-bit DOS and Windows software will simply not run on 64-bit versions of Windows without an additional software such as DosBox.



SkiFree 16-bit a game that shipped with Windows 3.1 running on a modern 64-bit Linux distribution under Wine.

Since Wine has invested in implementing core Windows features, it is even possible to compile Wine for Windows and use it as a compatibility layer for such old software. This makes Wine an invaluable tool for running very old games. Compiling Wine for Windows and using it to run old software isn't for the faint hearted, it's easier to just use Linux, if only in a VM.

Wine is a very general piece of software, another similar approach that people interested in preserving old games have taken, is in recreating just their game engines in such a way that they run